Elite Workout Manual

Chapter 5 – Pull Day (Strength, Back & Pull-up Development)

Objective

Build a strong back, improve posture, increase grip strength, and progress toward your first strict pull-up while supporting cricket and pickleball performance.

Order	Exercise	Sets	Reps	RPE	Rest
0	Scapular Pull-ups (Warm-up)	2	8–10	6	60 s
1	Assisted Pull-ups / Negatives	4	4–6	8	2 min
2	Chest-Supported T-Bar Row	4	6–8	8	2 min
3	Neutral-Grip Lat Pulldown	3	8–10	8	90 s
4A	Single-Arm High Cable Row	3	10–12	8	—
4B	Straight-Arm Cable Pulldown	3	12–15	8	75 s
5A	Incline Dumbbell Curl	3	10–12	8	—
5B	Hammer Curl	3	10–12	8	60 s
6A	EZ-Bar Reverse Curl	2	15	8	—
6B	Dead Hang	3	20–45 sec	—	60 s

Why Pull-ups First?

Your primary skill goal is your first strict pull-up. Skill work is performed first while you are fresh to maximize neural adaptations and quality repetitions.

Grip & Forearm Focus

Dead hangs and reverse curls improve grip endurance, brachioradialis strength, and shoulder stability, supporting both pull-ups and racket sports.

Technique Cues

Initiate every pull by depressing the shoulder blades. Pull elbows toward your hips, avoid shrugging, and control the lowering phase for 2–3 seconds.

Common Mistakes

Using momentum, pulling behind the neck, curling the weight instead of rowing, and rushing the eccentric phase.

Progression

Reduce assistance on pull-ups whenever you can complete all prescribed reps with good technique. Increase rowing and pulldown loads once you reach the top of the rep range with 1–2 reps in reserve.